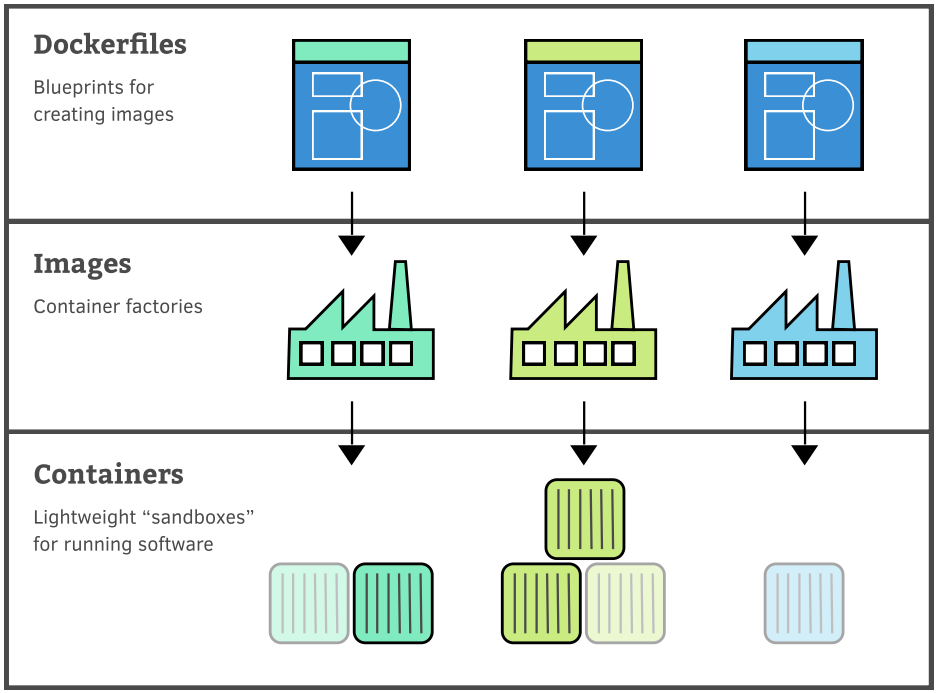


Here's a basic Dockerfile for running our Rails app. It's not perfect—we'll make several improvements in Chapter 3, Fine-Tuning Our Rails Image, on page 31—but it's good enough for now. There's no need to create this file; for now we'll just discuss it:

```
FROM ruby:2.6

RUN apt-get update -yqq
RUN apt-get install -yqq --no-install-recommends nodejs

COPY . /usr/src/app/

WORKDIR /usr/src/app
RUN bundle install
```

Every image has to start from something: another, preexisting image. For that reason, every Dockerfile begins with a FROM instruction, which specifies the image to use as its starting point. Typically, we'll look for a starting image that's close to what we need but more general. That way we can extend and customize it to our needs.

The first line of our Dockerfile is

```
FROM ruby:2.6
```